

**THE
PATRIARCHS
IN KARNATAKA
ARE LOOKING
TO THE
WOMEN IN
THEIR CLANS
TO CARRY ON
THE FAMILY
NAME IN
POLITICS.**

BANGALORE | Daughters Dearest

Daughters are clearly the dearest in Karnataka these days. State patriarchs have identified three women to er... carry on the family name. Last year Mamta Nichani, daughter of Ramakrishna Hegde, contested elections. This year H.D. Deve Gowda's daughter-in-law Anitha Kumaraswamy won a seat from Madhugiri. Now there's a buzz that former Maharashtra governor S.M. Krishna will field daughter

Sambhavi in the forthcoming elections. Why not? Daddy's days are over, anyway.

by Swagata Sen



ANITHA KUMARASWAMY

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PATNA | Divided They Stand

In ironic contrast to its lofty name the United Progressive Alliance (UPA) is a divided house in Bihar. UPA allies—the Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) and the Lok Janshakti Party (LJP)—are at loggerheads again after LJP president Ram Vilas Paswan said it is now his turn to lead the UPA not only in Bihar but also in Delhi. As a means of putting pressure on Lalu, Paswan has decided to contest 16 seats in the Lok Sabha polls, twice what he was allotted last time. Paswan's RJD 'ally', however, has held his peace so far—but for how long?

by Amitabh Srivastava



LALU WITH PASWAN

KRISHNA MURARI KISHAN

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM | Stealing His March

On the day CPI(M)'s state Secretary Pinarayi Vijayan launched his pre-election march, the Kerala High Court issued him a notice in the Rs 370-crore Lavalin scam case related to irregularities in the contract given to the Canadian firm SNC Lavalin for renovating three hydropower stations. The contract was awarded when Vijayan was the power minister in the LDF government. Once Chief Minister V.S. Achuthanandan's demand for Vijayan's removal was rejected by the Politburo, he kept away from the march whose slogan was, "Secure India, prosperous Kerala".

by M.G. Radhakrishnan



SK MOHAN

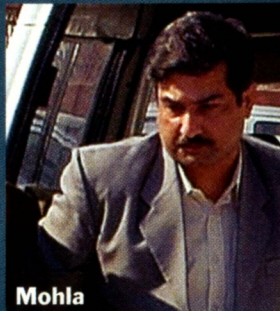
A POSTER ATTACKING VIJAYAN



golden pumpkin

IDEALLY THERE should be a photograph of Jitender Kumar Mohla at every Indian airport to prevent him from getting into an aircraft ever again. Because high altitude goes to his head. Mohla, the passenger who precipitated the Indigo Air 'hijack' crisis, has tried to explain his erratic behaviour as a 'panic attack.' A Delhi chartered

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Mohla

accountant before an identity crisis (and something to drink) hit him hard up in the air, Mohla claimed to be, in turns, a sky marshal, a civil aviation official, an ex-IAF pilot and a terrorist. Harassed passengers could have answered the question as to who Mohla really was in two words: a nuisance and a menace. His actions brought out the NSG and threw air traffic into disarray. The only good that can now come from the episode is to make an example of Mohla as a warning to all aspiring copycats.